

In the second category, there are, again, two types of sockets: Socket 478 for Intel, and Socket A for the newer AMD Athlon and Duron range of processors. Newer Pentium IV processors for the PCI-Express chipset use the LGA 775 socket, while AMD 64 chips use either Socket 754 or 939.

The above information is necessary since you need to understand what you're upgrading your CPU to, and how to do it. Whenever you hear sockets mentioned, the term refers to the white socket, usually square, on the top of the motherboard: this is what the processor goes into.

When we talk about a 'Slot' type of processor, it refers to a dark brown slot on the motherboard that is completely isolated from all the PCI and AGP slots. The processor is rectangular and mounts vertically like an add-on card into the slot. The images below will help you understand what we're talking about.

Now that we have seen what processors go into what kind of slot type, let's try removing and installing some into their respective slots. While we do this, it is important to understand that while the Slot type of processors do not need to have their heat-sinks and cooling fans removed to remove the processor, Socket-type processors do: the processor is secured completely in the socket while the heat sink is mounted on top of the processor, and the cooling fan is mounted on the top of the heat sink.

The heat-sink and cooling fan mechanism is secured by a latch on the top of the motherboard. The processor can be removed by pulling gently on the plastic or metal lever on the side of the socket. Once this lever reaches up, gently pull out the processor.

A completely installed slot processor

